BUSINESS PLAN

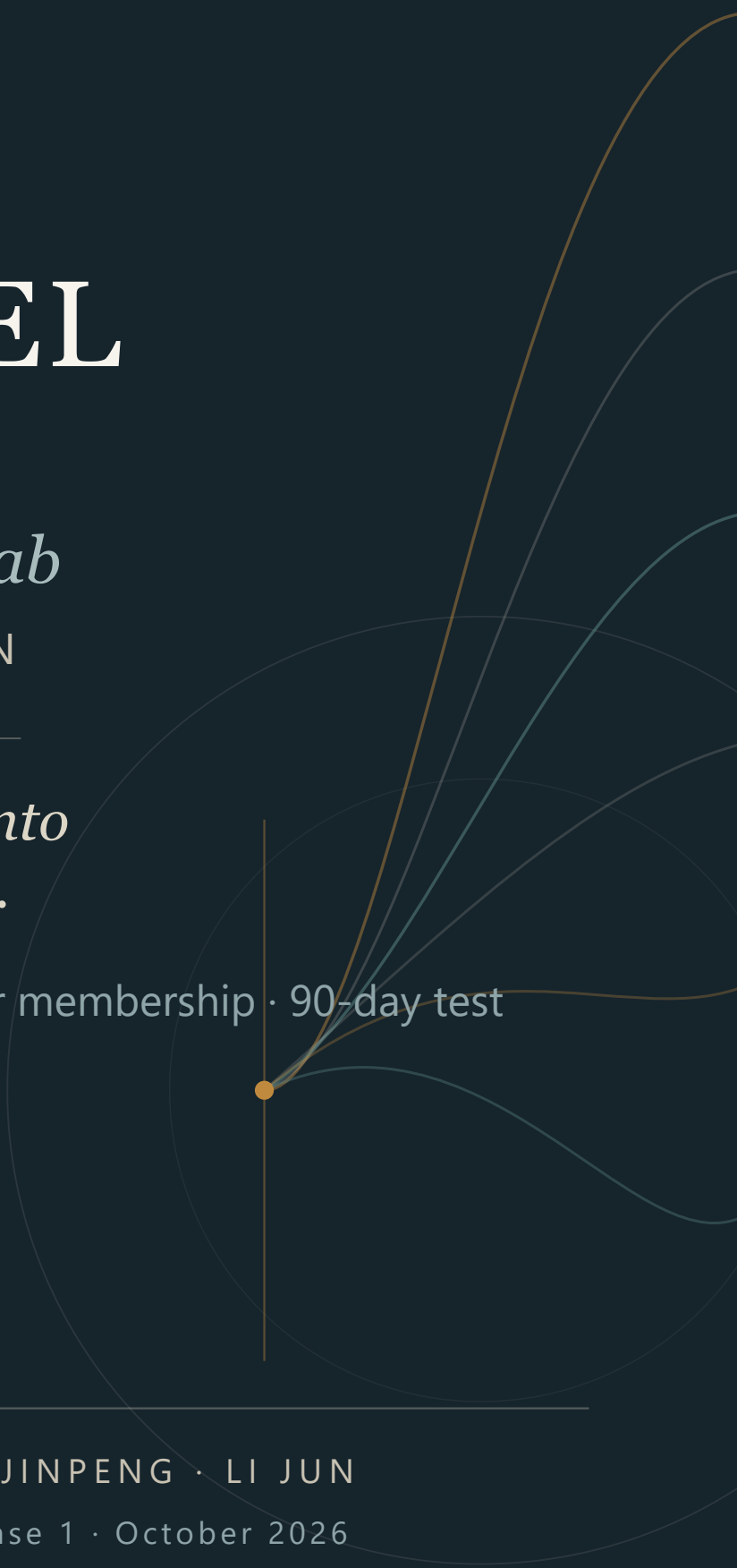
PARALLEL ME

Life Experiment Lab

PHASE 1 BUSINESS PLAN

Turn a career label into a testable experience.

Guangzhou pilot · Three-tier membership · 90-day test



TEAM 11 · WU PEIXI · HE JINPENG · LI JUN

Mobile App Development · Phase 1 · October 2026

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Executive summary

Most career decisions are made from a label: a major name, a job title, or a story someone else tells. Parallel Me turns that label into a short, bounded, testable experience.

The product serves three groups. The first is students who are unsure about a major or a first job and have no first-hand evidence. The second is adults who want to enrich their lives by trying photography, coffee, craft or content work. The third is mid-career professionals who want to change direction but must consider income, qualifications and family constraints. All three lack the same thing: a low-cost way to find out what the work actually feels like.

The experience has six steps. An AI dialogue turns a vague intention into time, budget, physical constraints and the part of the job the user most wants to test. It produces an editable plan of daily tasks with three depths: a rough introduction, a deeper experience, and an immersive week. The system then rehearses the plan against city, weather and commute constraints. If the local supply is available and authorised, the user observes a host for up to five days and then performs controlled tasks for up to five days. The loop closes with a daily check-in and a light review.

The first market is Guangzhou. The pilot recruits students around the University Town in Panyu and builds supply in Haizhu and Tianhe with three low-risk occupations: coffee, photography and content creation. The commercial model has three tiers: a free digital experience; a digital subscription from ¥15 per week that allows same-city bookings with a 10% service fee; and Plus from ¥40 per week with a dedicated coordinator and cross-city booking in cities that are already live, with a 5% service fee. The cost of an offline experience is quoted separately and transparently.

The 90-day validation budget is ¥18,000, excluding salaries and product development. The test targets 40,000 reach, 800 visits, 240 sign-ups, 120 completed plans and 30 completed experiences. Thirty completions is a validation target, and ¥600 per completion is a validation cost, not a mature customer-acquisition cost. If authorisation, safety or supply is not ready, the offline budget is held rather than spent.

3 groups
Students · life enrichers · career changers

6 steps
Dialogue to review, with offline safety checks

Guangzhou
First city; Foshan and Shenzhen follow

The pilot has to prove one thing: in Guangzhou, an ordinary user can complete a safe, authorised and explainable career experience, and is willing to pay for the membership or the service fee. Scale, national coverage and social features come after that evidence.

PART I · PROBLEM

01 The problem and the users

Career choice is hard not because information is scarce, but because most information is far from what the work feels like when you do it.

1.1 A career label is not an experience

Students see a list of major names when they apply and a list of job titles when they graduate. Adults who want to try photography or coffee first meet course advertising. Mid-career professionals who consider a change start with income, mortgage and family costs. The situations look different, but the gap is the same: imagination is standing in for experience.

Imagination keeps the visible part of a job and removes the rest. A student may like the creative idea of architecture without knowing how much of the week goes into coordination, revisions and site visits. Someone may like the freedom of photography without knowing how much time goes into deadlines, quotes and client changes. These differences only become clear by doing.

1.2 Three user segments

Segment	Situation	What is missing	Pilot service
Confused students 18–24	Choosing a major, seeking an internship, preparing for a first job; know only names and images	No first-hand evidence, and no way to tell which part they dislike	Recruit in University Town; digital plan plus up to 5 days of observation
Life enrichers	Stable job; want to try photography, coffee, craft or content creation	No entry point and no structure for limited free time	Half-day to two-day experiences; tasks can be split
Career changers 40–55	Worried about income, qualifications and family duties; cannot simply resign	A low-cost test, not another career assessment	Digital dialogue and tasks first; short observation later; no promise of a job

1.3 Three people

Lin Yue, 20, first-year architecture. She thinks architects are cool, but has never seen what a real working day contains. She wants to follow one for a day to find out whether she likes design itself or only the idea of being an architect.

Zhou Shan, 34, administration manager. She has wanted to learn photography for years, but courses cost thousands and she is not sure she will enjoy the work. She would rather spend a weekend assisting a working photographer on a real shoot.

Chen Kai, 45, manufacturing middle manager. His industry is shrinking. He has thought about coffee or content work, but mortgage and school fees make him cautious. He needs a test with a visible cost, not encouragement.

1.4 Why existing answers fall short

Content platforms provide stories. Job boards provide vacancies. Career assessments provide labels. Offline workshops provide a single taste. Each is useful, but none turns “I want to try” into a sequence of tasks, observation, practice and a record that can be reviewed later.

This is why Parallel Me is not a course, a recruiter or a therapy service. Courses sell knowledge, recruiters sell matches, and therapy addresses emotional health. The product sells a bounded first attempt before a decision.

1.5 Why now

China’s higher-education enrolment was about 48.73 million in 2025, and the 2026 graduating cohort is estimated at 12.7 million. Guangzhou’s statistical handbook records 84 higher-education institutions and about 1.5147 million students in 2024. These numbers indicate where seed users can be found; they do not indicate how many will pay.

The pilot therefore treats market size as a starting point for recruitment, not as revenue. The next chapter explains how the number is narrowed before any financial claim is made.

PART I · PRODUCT

02 Product: the six-step experience

The product does not give the user an answer. It turns “I want to try” into six steps that can be completed within a month.

2.1 The six-step journey

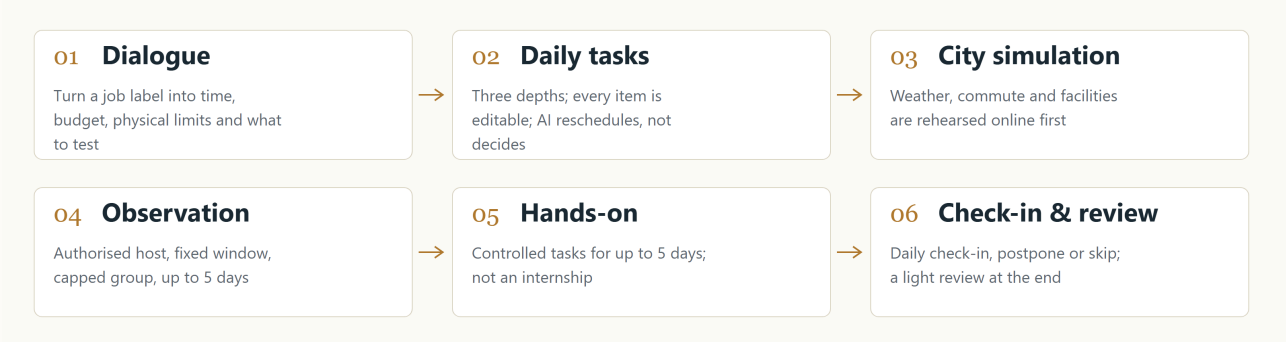


Figure 1. The six-step experience. Steps 1–3 are online; steps 4–5 are offline and controlled; step 6 returns to daily life.

2.2 Step 1: dialogue that turns a label into a testable goal

The dialogue does not assign a personality type. It asks for four kinds of information: available hours per week, budget ceiling, physical or commute constraints, and the part of the work the user most wants to test. For occupations with entry requirements, the system cites public information about licences or qualifications and states clearly that this is not an eligibility decision.

Each dialogue ends with an editable plan: what will be tested, over how long, which three tasks come first, and when the user should stop. The plan is not a contract; the user can change it at any point.

2.3 Step 2: daily tasks at three depths

The same occupation can be explored at three depths. **A rough introduction** uses reading, short interviews and video to build basic awareness. **A deeper experience** assigns three to seven days of concrete tasks. **An immersive week** arranges a fuller schedule within safety limits. Every task has editable duration and intensity; the AI reschedules the plan instead of deciding for the user.

For photography, a plan might include: review three styles, join one outdoor shoot, complete a 30-minute shoot independently, and write a short review. If the user cuts the outdoor shoot from a full day to half a day, the system moves later tasks and lowers the total intensity.

2.4 Step 3: city and weather simulation

Offline experience is shaped by the city and the weather. The system uses public weather, commute and facility data to rehearse the plan online: what happens if it rains, whether a two-hour commute is worth it,

when the venue closes, and where the user can rest. The simulation is indicative, not a guarantee, but it removes obviously unrealistic plans before a booking is made.

2.5 Step 4: observation, up to five days

The user is matched with an authorised local host and observes for up to five days without disrupting normal work. Observation has fixed windows, a capped number of visitors and compensation for the host. The host can refuse filming or refuse access to certain areas. Observation is not employment or an internship, and it does not create a labour relationship.

2.6 Step 5: hands-on practice, up to five days

The user performs controlled tasks: pulling an espresso shot, setting up a lighting rig, or writing a short script with a content team. Each task is assessed for safety. Tasks involving heat, knives, equipment or customers have explicit limits. Licensed professions such as medicine and law are not offered as offline experiences in Phase 1; they are replaced by online tasks or public talks.

2.7 Step 6: check-in, postponement and light review

The app shows only the tasks for that day. Completing a task checks it off. Missing a day allows the user to postpone or skip without penalty. The review is deliberately short: which moment felt most like the user, which moment made them want to quit, and what they would change next time. Rewards and social features are later additions, not substitutes for completion.

2.8 Who does what

Step	User	AI / product	Host or partner
1 Dialogue	Answers concrete questions; edits the goal	Asks one question at a time; produces the plan	—
2 Tasks	Chooses depth; edits time and intensity	Generates and reschedules tasks	—
3 Simulation	Confirms constraints	Checks weather, commute and facilities	—
4 Observation	Observes, asks, records	Matches, authorises, collects feedback	Opens a fixed window; sets boundaries
5 Practice	Performs controlled tasks	Provides safety brief and check-in	Supervises; can stop the task
6 Review	Answers three questions	Stores the record; suggests next step	Receives a short summary

2.9 Product boundaries

- **Not recruitment:** no job offer, no internship, no labour relationship.
- **Not therapy:** no diagnosis or treatment; crisis language is escalated to a human.
- **Not a course:** no systematic curriculum; the product sells a designed and accompanied attempt.
- **Not nationwide:** bookings open only in cities with signed supply and a safety process.

PART II · MARKET

03 Market: Guangzhou scenario pool

Market sizing starts by admitting that population is not demand, and demand is not supply.

3.1 External baseline

Measure	Value	Use in this plan
China higher-education enrolment, 2025	**48.73 million**	Background demand for career exploration
2026 graduating cohort (estimate)	**12.7 million**	Timing window for student demand
Guangzhou higher-education students, 2024	**1.5147 million** (84 institutions)	Seed-user pool for the pilot

Sources: Ministry of Education public data; Guangzhou Statistical Information Handbook 2025. These are external statistics, not users of the product.

3.2 Guangzhou scenario funnel

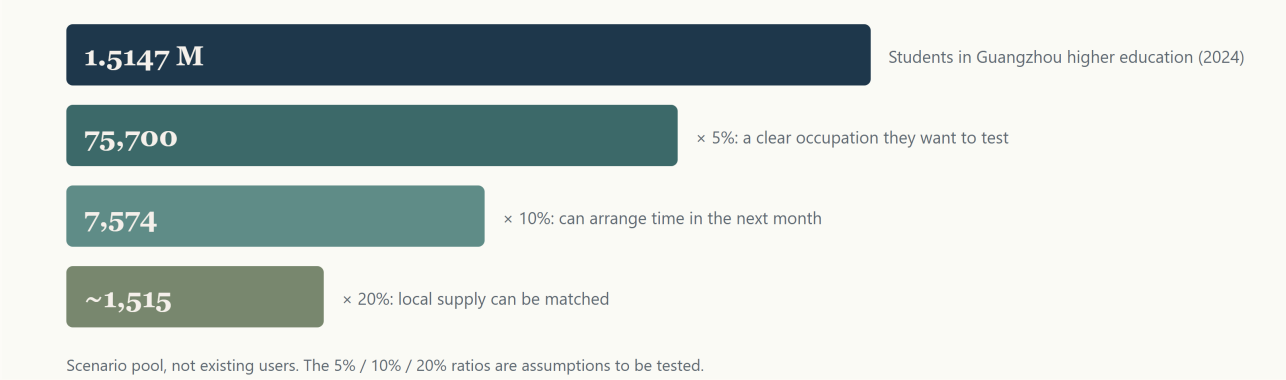


Figure 2. Guangzhou student scenario pool. The 5% / 10% / 20% ratios are assumptions, not survey findings.

1.5147 million × 5% (a clear occupation to test) ≈ 75,700; × 10% (able to arrange time) ≈ 7,574; × 20% (local supply can be matched) ≈ 1,515.

The 1,515 is a scenario pool, not registered users and not paying users. It helps the team size the supply, the booking system and the number of offline sessions. Each ratio has to be corrected with interviews and real bookings.

3.3 Supply is the binding constraint

A user who wants to shadow a doctor does not create a hospital willing to host. A user who wants to try photography does not create a photographer with spare time. In Phase 1, supply — hosts who will authorise, set boundaries and host reliably — is the constraint, not demand. Guangzhou starts with coffee, photography and content creation because they are low-risk and relatively easy to observe.

3.4 Capacity math

Six hosts across three occupations, each offering two slots per month, produce 12 slots per month and 36 slots over 90 days. The target of 30 completions therefore uses about 83% of planned capacity. If fewer than six hosts sign, the pilot reduces the target rather than overloading the hosts.

3.5 Why Guangzhou

Guangzhou combines three conditions: a concentrated student entry point in Panyu University Town; dense coffee, photography and content scenes in Haizhu and Tianhe; and manageable commute and language costs inside the city. Proving the authorisation, booking, observation, practice and review loop in one city is more controllable than launching across the province.

PART II · COMPETITION

04 Competition: from information to evidence

Adjacent products are strong. The opportunity is not to beat them on job volume or content traffic, but to cover the gap between information and a decision.

4.1 Existing alternatives

Alternative	What it solves	Gap
BOSS Zhipin, Interns	Finding a job or an internship	A vacancy is not an experience; the user still does not know how the work feels
KanZhun	Company information, salaries, interview reports	The information belongs to someone else
Xiaohongshu, Bilibili	Career stories and lifestyle content	Engaging but not executable, and hard to verify
Offline workshops	A one-off craft, coffee or photography session	No front-end dialogue, follow-up tasks or review
Parallel Me	Dialogue, tasks, observation, practice and review in one sequence	Needs local supply and safe delivery, so expansion is slow

4.2 Positioning

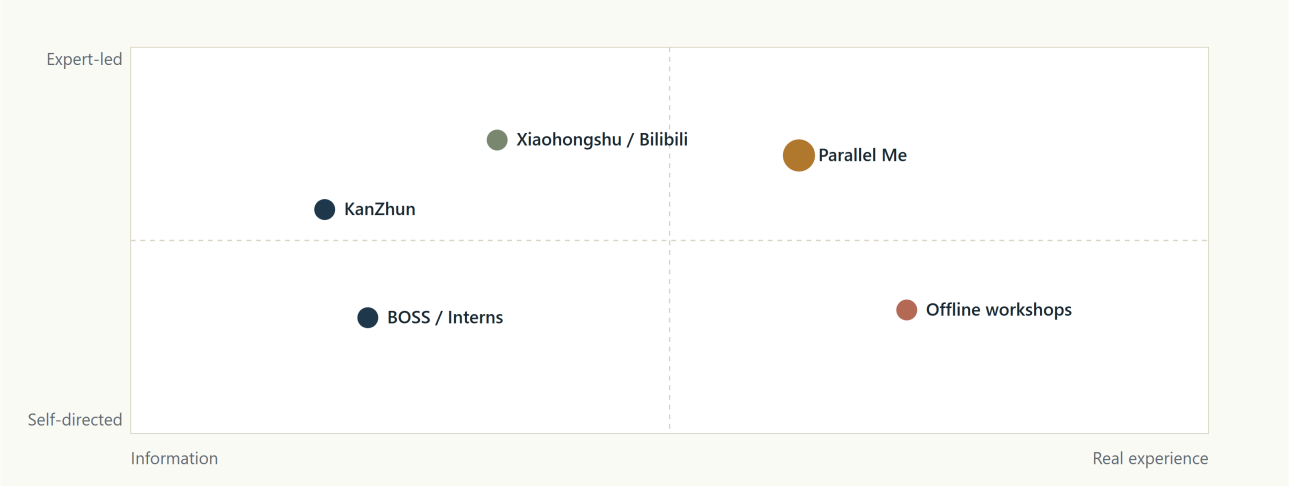


Figure 3. Competitive positioning. The horizontal axis moves from information to real experience; the vertical axis from expert-led to self-directed.

4.3 Differentiation

The user leaves with a record, not a bookmark: why they wanted to try, which tasks they completed, when they wanted to stop, which moment felt most like them, and whether they would continue. That record

can feed the next dialogue and inform the next decision.

4.4 What is hard to copy

- **Safety task templates:** what can and cannot be done in each occupation, the risks, the permissions and the emergency process. These are built one occupation at a time.
- **Authorised local supply:** hosts willing to open a window, be trained and follow a standard are scarce.
- **Reliable post-experience feedback:** completed records improve the templates and the host screening.

Calling an AI model is not a moat. Models can be replicated; templates, supply and feedback cannot.

4.5 Competitive discipline

Phase 1 does not compete on the number of job listings, occupations or cities. It competes on three measures: completion, safety and willingness to pay. If completion or safety fails, the product changes before expansion.

PART III · BUSINESS MODEL

05 Business model: three-tier membership

The model separates the digital subscription, the offline coordination fee and the cost of the experience itself.

5.1 Three tiers

Tier	What is included	Offline booking
Free digital	Dialogue, first week of tasks, basic check-in	Not available
Digital subscription	Full task library, three depths, plan editing, review record	Same-city booking; **10%** service fee on the confirmed experience cost
Plus	All digital features, dedicated back-office coordinator, cross-city booking in live cities	**5%** service fee

5.2 Prices

Tier	Weekly	Monthly	Quarterly	Yearly
Digital subscription	¥15	¥55	¥155	¥600
Plus	¥40	¥150	¥420	¥1,600
Student subscription (23% off)	~¥12	~¥42	~¥119	~¥462
Student Plus (23% off)	~¥31	~¥116	~¥323	~¥1,232

The student discount applies to membership only, not to the experience cost or service fee. Figures are rounded for presentation; the booking page is authoritative.

5.3 Service fee, quoted separately

Offline experience costs vary widely: a coffee session may be tens of yuan, while a photography day may be several hundred. A fixed ticket would cross-subsidise the cheap and the expensive, and would hide the real price. The host quotes the confirmed experience cost before booking; the platform charges 10% for digital subscribers and 5% for Plus members.

> **Example.** An experience quoted at ¥800 costs a digital subscriber ¥800 + ¥80 service fee; a Plus member pays ¥800 + ¥40. Membership is charged separately. Transport, accommodation and insurance are itemised on the booking page rather than bundled by default.

5.4 Unit economics

Scenario	User pays	Platform keeps	Note
Digital subscription only (month)	¥55	~¥47	After AI, payment and messaging costs of about 15%
Subscription + one ¥800 experience	¥55 + ¥80	~¥123	The ¥800 goes to the host; the platform does not handle it
Plus (month) + one ¥800 experience	¥150 + ¥40	~¥175	Plus includes a coordinator, so variable cost is slightly higher

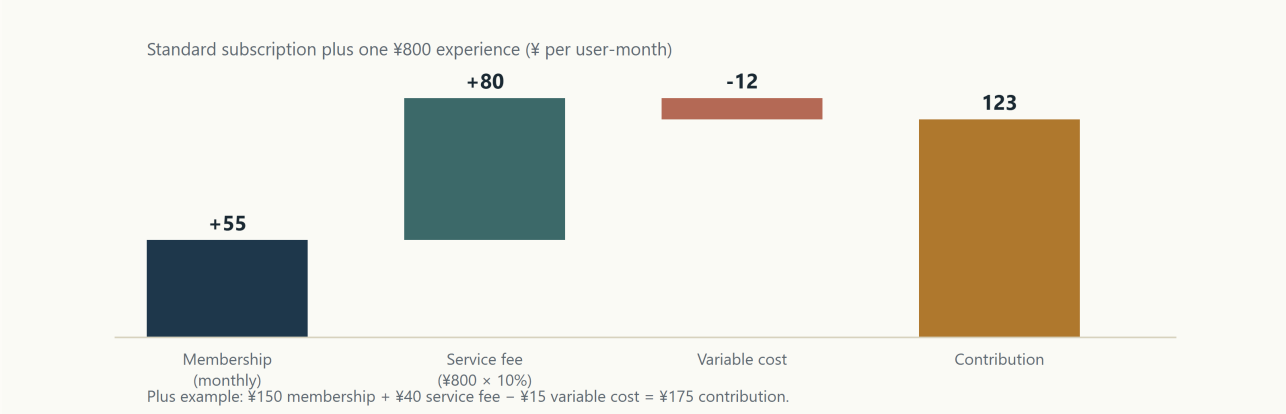


Figure 4. Unit economics for a standard subscriber who completes one ¥800 experience.

Excludes founder salaries, office and full commercial insurance. This is a unit example, not a profit forecast.

5.5 Break-even and sensitivity

Fixed operating costs in the 12-month scenario are ¥42,000: part-time supply operations ¥24,000, content ¥12,000 and safety/insurance ¥6,000. A paying user contributes about ¥375 a year after variable costs and one offline completion. Break-even is therefore roughly 112 paying users, or 7.5% of 1,500 sign-ups.

Paid conversion (of 1,500 sign-ups)	5%	10%	15%
Paying users	75	150	225
Subscription revenue (¥60 × 6 months)	¥27,000	¥54,000	¥81,000
Service fee (80% completion × ¥60)	¥3,600	¥7,200	¥10,800
Variable cost (8%)	¥2,448	¥4,896	¥7,344
Fixed operating cost	¥42,000	¥42,000	¥42,000
Contribution	**−¥13,848**	**¥14,304**	**¥42,456**

Assumes an average monthly membership fee of ¥60, six months of subscription, and 80% of paying users completing one ¥600 experience. Excludes founder salaries and office.

5.6 Why not a fixed ticket

A fixed ticket suits a standardised product, not a non-standard experience. Splitting the price into membership, experience cost and service fee gives the user a clear breakdown, lets the host quote cost, and avoids hiding subsidies. The trade-off is a more complex booking page, which must itemise every charge.

5.7 Conditions for scale

Expansion starts only when local supply density is sufficient, completion is stable and repeat purchase appears. The pilot does not measure registration volume; it measures 30 real completions, zero serious safety incidents and 10 paying users.

PART III · GO-TO-MARKET

06 Go-to-market: the 90-day test

The pilot does not buy scale. It uses content and campus partnerships to find people willing to complete an experience, then lets completion decide whether a channel deserves more budget.

6.1 Channel roles

Channel	Role	Format
Xiaohongshu	Occupation search, real notes, booking conversion	“A day with a photographer”, “first day as a barista”
Bilibili	Longer content that builds trust	10–15 minute experience documentary
Douyin	Short-video topic testing	30–60 second task clips
WeChat + campus clubs	Sign-up, attendance, follow-up	Community recruitment, event notices, review surveys

6.2 The campaign: “Parallel Life Trial Opening”

Pick an occupation, receive a task card, complete one safe experiment, share the real takeaway voluntarily, and invite one friend. The objective is not views; it is completed tasks. All filming and sharing require prior consent from the user and the host.

6.3 The 90-day sequence

- **Month 1 — interviews and supply.** 20 interviews (12 students, 8 adults); approach six coffee, photography and content teams; aim for two hosts in each of three occupations.
- **Month 2 — content and digital plans.** Publish eight real experience pieces; open 120 digital plans; measure first-week task completion.
- **Month 3 — a small number of offline sessions.** After authorisation, insurance assessment and emergency procedures are ready, run 10–15 observation or practice sessions to reach 30 completions.

6.4 Budget

Item	Amount	Purpose
Content production	¥6,000	Filming, editing and visual notes; founders appear themselves rather than outsourcing a large production
Interviews and supply	¥4,000	Travel, venues, host communication and training
Paid tests	¥4,000	Small Xiaohongshu and Douyin tests, not a large media buy
Safety and insurance	¥3,000	Per-session insurance assessment and emergency supplies
Travel and misc.	¥1,000	Local transport, printing and consumables
Total	**¥18,000**	Excludes product development, salaries and full commercial insurance

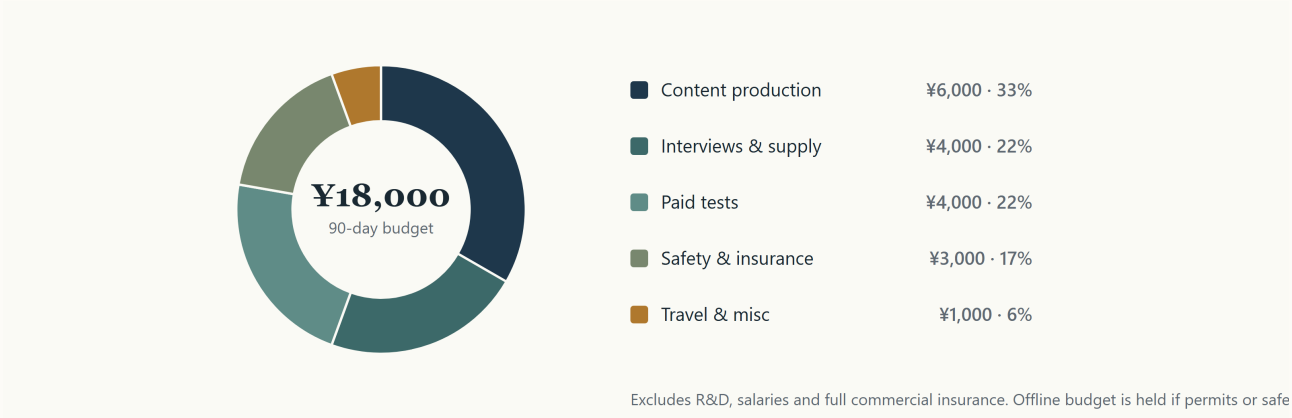


Figure 5. Allocation of the 90-day budget. Offline budget is held if authorisation or safety is not ready.

6.5 Conversion funnel

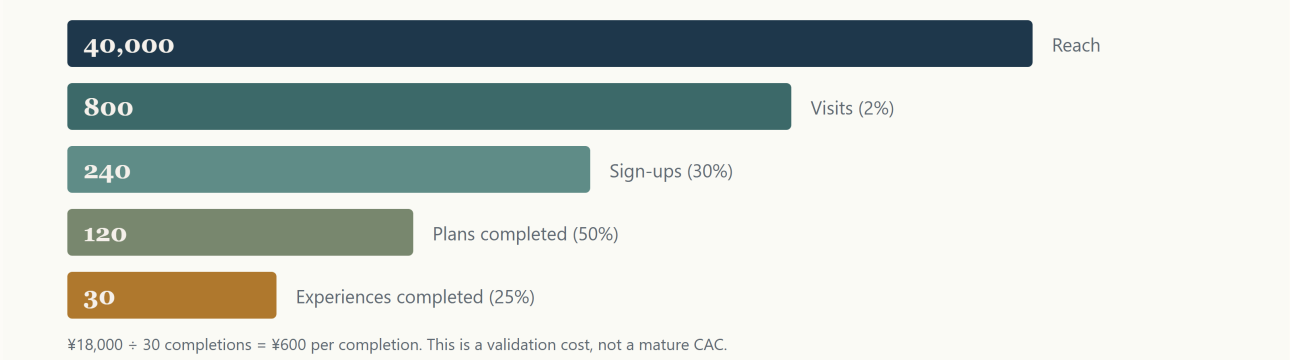


Figure 6. The 90-day test targets 40,000 reach, 800 visits, 240 sign-ups, 120 completed plans and 30 completions.

At ¥18,000, 30 completions imply ¥600 per completion. This is a validation cost, not a mature acquisition cost: it includes content, supply development and one-off safety work.

6.6 Three rules

- Do not promote supply that has not signed; do not describe an intention as a partnership.
- If completion is below target, change the product and the tasks before spending more on media.
- If authorisation and safety are not ready, hold the offline budget rather than forcing a session.

PART IV · OPERATIONS

07 Operations and supply

An offline experience does not end when the user reaches the venue. Authorisation, training, safety and feedback are part of the product.

7.1 The first three occupations

Occupation	Location	Why first
Coffee	Independent cafés in Haizhu and Tianhe	Relatively standard process, controllable risk, higher willingness to host
Photography	Studios in Haizhu; outdoor teams in Tianhe	Strong interest from both students and adults; can be split into observation, assisting and a short independent shoot
Content creation	Small content teams in Tianhe	Relevant to student majors; online tasks can start earlier

7.2 Host recruitment and screening

A host is a local practitioner willing to open an observation window and follow a standard. Screening has four steps: application and authorisation, an interview covering work rhythm, hosting willingness and safety conditions, training on task boundaries, filming consent and emergency procedures, and one trial session with two-way feedback. Failure at any step keeps the host off the list.

Hosts receive three things: a clear window and visitor cap, per-session compensation, and the right to refuse filming or end a session. The platform does not treat hosts as attractions, and does not allow users to occupy their time indefinitely.

7.3 Safety flow

- **Before booking:** disclose the experience, risks, what to bring and cancellation rules; minors require guardian consent.
- **On arrival:** both sides confirm the task boundary; the host decides whether to open heat, knife, equipment or customer-facing steps.
- **During:** an emergency contact is available; if the user feels unwell or a conflict arises, the session stops and the user is not blamed for “not completing”.
- **After:** follow-up within 24 hours; serious incidents trigger a review and may pause the host or the occupation.

7.4 Quality control

Each occupation has a task template: what can be done, what cannot, the completion standard, required authorisation and common risks. After a session, users rate three things: clarity of the task, willingness of the host to explain, and whether they would recommend it. A host with two consecutive low scores is paused for retraining.

7.5 Supply KPIs

The pilot tracks four numbers: signed hosts (target six, two per occupation), bookable slots, completion rate and host willingness to continue. If any is below target, the team does not add occupations or cities.

PART IV · TECHNOLOGY

08 Technology and delivery

The first version does not train a model. It uses an existing LLM, a structured dialogue, task templates and public data to run the six steps and to put safety into the back office.

8.1 Architecture

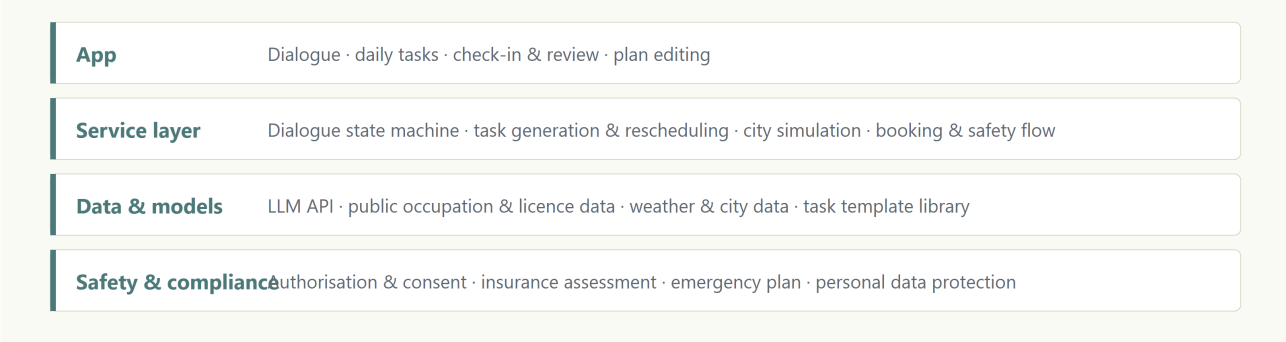


Figure 7. System architecture. The user app does four things: dialogue, tasks, check-in and review. Safety and compliance cut across all layers.

8.2 Dialogue and task generation

The dialogue runs as a state machine. It asks one question at a time and collects information in a fixed order: time, budget, physical constraints, the part of the work to test, and entry requirements. Task generation uses a template library plus parameters: occupation, depth, weekly hours, budget and city. If the user edits any parameter, the system reschedules and shows the effect: a longer cycle or lower intensity.

Public qualification information is used only as a prompt. For example, “this occupation usually requires a licence” includes a source and an update date, and reminds the user that the official requirement prevails.

8.3 City and weather simulation

Public weather and city-facility data support three checks: whether the weather suits an outdoor step, how long the commute takes, and when the venue closes. The result is labelled as indicative. In extreme weather, the default is to reschedule rather than proceed.

8.4 Check-in and back office

The user sees only today’s tasks. Completion checks the task; a missed day can be postponed or skipped. The host back office shows schedule, visitor list, safety brief and incident reporting. The operations dashboard shows completion, cancellation, incidents and ratings. The first version has no public leaderboard and no complex social features.

8.5 Data and privacy

The design follows China’s Personal Information Protection Law and Data Security Law: private by default, minimum collection, and user access, correction and deletion. Personal content is not used for advertising and is not sold. Offline filming requires separate consent, which can be withdrawn.

8.6 What the first version does not build

- No public feed, private chat or experience buddy matching; these come after validation.
- No nationwide booking; only signed cities and reviewed occupations.
- No offline experience in licensed professions; medicine and law start with online tasks or public talks.
- No automatic qualification decision, no psychological diagnosis and no promise of a career outcome.

PART V · ROADMAP

09 Roadmap: Guangzhou, Foshan, Shenzhen

Expansion follows supply and safety, not population alone.

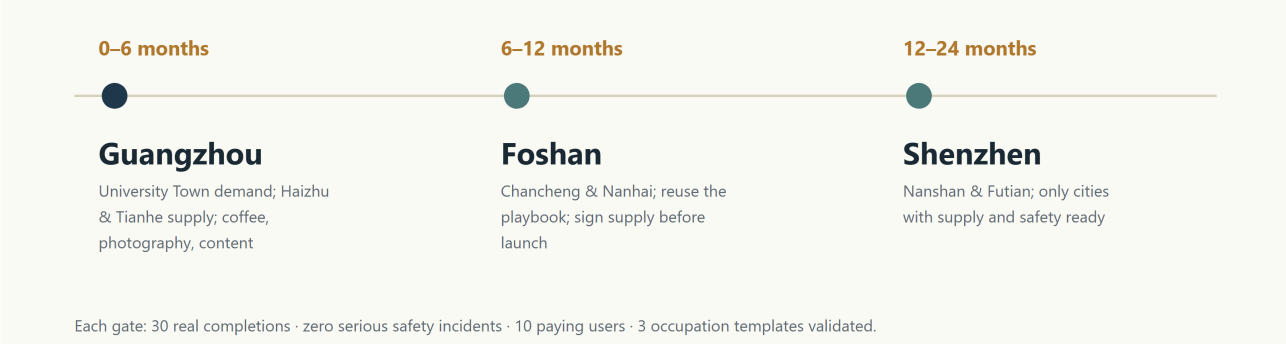


Figure 8. Guangdong rollout. Each new city signs supply and completes the safety process before any promotion or booking opens.

9.1 Months 0–6: Guangzhou

Recruit students in Panyu University Town; build coffee, photography and content supply in Haizhu and Tianhe. The goal is 30 completions, zero serious incidents and 10 paying users, with a reusable task template and safety process.

9.2 Months 6–12: Foshan

Start with Chancheng and Nanhai, reusing the Guangzhou occupation templates and host training manual. Sign local supply before promotion; occupations without supply do not open for booking.

9.3 Months 12–24: Shenzhen

Study Nanshan and Futian, but open only when local supply, authorisation and safety are ready. The Plus cross-city benefit covers live cities only; it is not a promise of nationwide access.

9.4 Gate for every phase

Before moving on, all five conditions must hold: 30 real completions, zero serious safety incidents, 10 paying users, three validated occupation templates, and at least 60% of hosts willing to continue. If any fails, the team stays and fixes it.

PART V · VALIDATION

10 Validation plan

The most important part of the plan is not the forecast. It is the set of numbers that tell the team to stop and change.

10.1 Hypotheses and pass lines

Hypothesis	How it is tested	Pass line
5% of students have a clear occupation to test	20 interviews (12 students, 8 adults)	At least 8 can name a specific occupation and the part they want to test
10% can arrange time	120 digital plans; observe the first week	At least 60 complete the first week of tasks
20% can be matched to supply	Two hosts in each of three occupations; open slots	At least six hosts can receive; weekends covered
Users will complete an offline experience	Real bookings over 90 days	30 completions; cancellation below 30%
Users will pay	A real paywall, not a survey	10 paying users (subscription or Plus)
Safety and authorisation are controllable	Every session recorded and followed up	Zero serious incidents; authorisation documents complete

10.2 The 90-day cadence

Month 1 covers interviews and supply. Month 2 covers content and digital plans. Month 3 runs a small number of offline sessions. The team reviews one page every week with four numbers only: new interviews, signed hosts, plan completion and offline completions. Revenue is not the first-week target.

10.3 When to stop or change

- **Interviews fail:** fewer than 8 of 20 can name a specific occupation → change the questions or the segment before running offline sessions.
- **Plans fail:** first-week completion below 30% → the tasks are too hard or too vague; fix the tasks before buying media.
- **Supply fails:** fewer than four hosts across three occupations → narrow to one or two occupations and go deeper.
- **Completion fails:** cancellation above 50% → inspect timing, price and communication; do not blame users.
- **Safety fails:** one serious incident → pause that occupation and review before restarting.

PART V · RISK

11 Risk and compliance

The risk is not in the model. It is offline: people can get hurt, hosts can be disturbed, and supply can run short.

Risk	How it shows up	Response
Personal and property safety	Burns from a coffee machine, damaged equipment, commute accidents	Low-risk occupations only; task grading; insurance assessment; emergency plan; guardian consent for minors
Disturbing hosts	Filming interrupts work; users stay too long; repeated questions	Fixed window, visitor cap, per-session compensation, host can stop at any time
Supply shortage	A requested occupation has no host; no available slot	Sign supply before promotion; open only live occupations; waiting list; no nationwide promise
Privacy and consent	Filming without consent, records exposed, data breach	Separate consent with withdrawal; private by default; minimum data; PIPL process
Legal boundary	Mistaken for recruitment, internship or therapy	State non-employment, non-internship and non-treatment; licensed occupations online only; clear terms
Reputation	One bad session spreads as “the platform is unreliable”	Fewer occupations and slots; no untrained hosts; fast follow-up and public correction

11.1 Safety is a veto

One serious incident can remove the reason to operate. Safety is therefore not “best effort”; if the authorisation, risk list, emergency contact and follow-up record are not ready, the session does not open.

11.2 Reputation

Career experience is infrequent and memorable. A single bad host can damage the brand far beyond one booking. The pilot deliberately keeps the number of occupations and slots small so that every session can be observed and improved.

PART V · FINANCE

12 Financials

The pilot money buys three assets: a validated task and safety template, a group of hosts willing to continue, and real completion and payment data.

12.1 The 90-day budget

The total is ¥18,000, excluding product development, salaries and full commercial insurance. The allocation is shown in Table 9 and Figure 5: content ¥6,000; interviews and supply ¥4,000; paid tests ¥4,000; safety and insurance ¥3,000; travel and misc. ¥1,000.

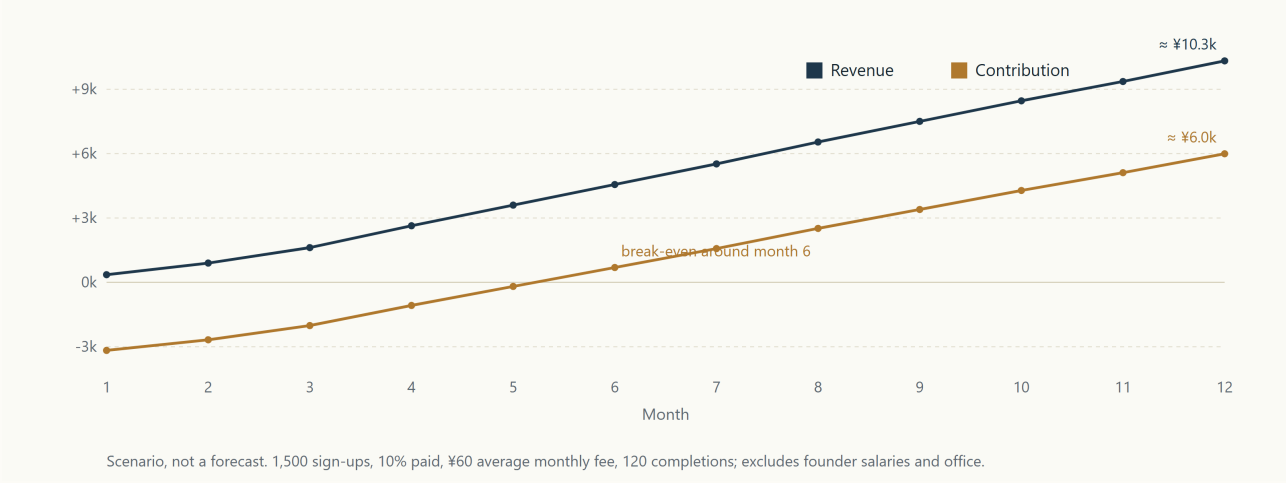
12.2 Unit economics

Item	Digital subscriber	Plus member
Experience cost (example)	¥800	¥800
Service fee	10%	5%
Platform service revenue	¥80	¥40
Membership (separate)	from ¥55 / month	from ¥150 / month
Platform variable cost (estimate)	~¥12	~¥15
Contribution per experience month	**~¥123**	**~¥175**

The experience cost is paid by the user to the host; the platform does not handle it. Transport, accommodation and insurance are itemised separately.

12.3 Twelve-month scenario

Assumption / line	Value
Sign-ups / paying users	1,500 / 150 (10%)
Average monthly fee / subscription months	¥60 / 6
Subscription revenue	150 × 60 × 6 = ¥54,000
Offline completions / average cost	120 / ¥600
Service fee revenue (10%)	120 × 600 × 10% = ¥7,200
Total revenue	**¥61,200**
AI, payment, messaging (8%)	¥4,896
Supply operations and support (part-time)	¥24,000
Content	¥12,000
Insurance and safety	¥6,000
Contribution (before founder salaries and office)	**≈ ¥14,300**



Scenario, not a forecast. 1,500 sign-ups, 10% paid, ¥60 average monthly fee, 120 completions; excludes founder salaries and office.

Figure 9. Monthly revenue and contribution under the 12-month scenario. Break-even occurs around month six; the figures are assumptions, not a forecast.

12.4 What changes the outcome

The largest sensitivities are paid conversion and completion. At 5% paid conversion the scenario loses about ¥13,800 before founder costs; at 15% it contributes about ¥42,500. A two-point change in conversion matters more than a small change in price, which is why the pilot measures real payment rather than stated willingness.

12.5 What the pilot money buys

The ¥18,000 is not expected to return a profit. It buys a validated template, a host network and a data set that determine whether the next stage deserves more capital. If the pilot fails, the loss is bounded and the reasons are documented.

PART VI · TEAM

13 Team and responsibilities

Three people, each owning one part of the pilot, with external advice where the team is thin.

Member	Responsibility	Phase 1 deliverable
Wu Peixi	Product and user research	Interview guide, dialogue script, task templates, prototype
He Jinpeng	Marketing and content	Xiaohongshu/Bilibili content, campus partnerships, trial campaign
Li Jun	Operations and supply	Host contracts, safety process, booking and on-site delivery
External adviser (to be appointed)	Career development and safety	Review task boundaries, safety checklist and crisis response

13.1 How the team works

Each person owns a number: product owns interviews and plan completion; marketing owns qualified sign-ups and content conversion; operations owns signed hosts and offline completions. The team reviews data once a week and discusses the next action, not impressions.

13.2 What is missing

The team lacks an adviser with offline event safety experience, a part-time operator who can maintain host relationships, and a campus contact in Guangzhou. The first two are covered by advisers or part-time help in Phase 1; full-time hiring waits for validation.

PART VI · CONCLUSION

14 Conclusion

The pilot does not promise that every occupation is available in every city. It promises one thing: in Guangzhou, a career experience can be safe, real and reviewable.

If, after 90 days, 30 people complete an experience, 10 are willing to pay and no serious safety incident occurs, the team has evidence to continue. If not, the team changes the tasks, the supply or the price rather than spending more on advertising.

A career decision should not rely on imagination alone. Parallel Me gives each user a bounded, low-cost trial before the decision.

> **Next steps.** Complete 20 interviews, sign six hosts, open 120 digital plans and run 30 offline completions. Use the data to decide whether Foshan is next.

APPENDIX A

Appendix A · Interview guide

1. When did you last seriously consider doing a different job or studying a different major? What happened?
2. What does that occupation actually do? Can you describe three everyday scenes?
3. What have you done about it — content, conversations, courses, spending?
4. If you could test it for one day, which part would you most want to see? Which part would you least want to do?
5. How many hours per week can you spare? Weekends or weekdays?
6. What is an acceptable budget for one experience? Can you accept membership and service fee being separate?
7. Are there physical, commute or family constraints?
8. If you disliked it, would you still consider the money well spent? Why?
9. Would you allow the platform to record your tasks and review? Which parts would you keep private?
10. What would worry you most about observing a practitioner for half a day?
11. Under what conditions would you cancel a booking? How much notice would you give?
12. Do you know anyone considering the same thing? Would you recommend it?

APPENDIX B

Appendix B · Assumptions and calculations

B.1 Guangzhou scenario pool

1.5147 million × 5% = 75,735; × 10% = 7,574; × 20% = 1,515. All three ratios are team assumptions to be corrected by interviews, bookings and supply data.

B.2 90-day funnel

40,000 reach × 2% = 800 visits; × 30% = 240 sign-ups; × 50% = 120 plans; × 25% = 30 completions. ¥18,000 ÷ 30 = ¥600 per completion.

B.3 Prices and discounts

Digital subscription: ¥15 / ¥55 / ¥155 / ¥600 (weekly/monthly/quarterly/yearly). Plus: ¥40 / ¥150 / ¥420 / ¥1,600. Student membership is 23% off; the discount applies to membership only. Service fee: 10% for digital subscription, 5% for Plus, on the confirmed experience cost.

B.4 Budget allocation

Content ¥6,000; interviews and supply ¥4,000; paid tests ¥4,000; safety and insurance ¥3,000; travel and misc. ¥1,000; total ¥18,000. Excludes product development, salaries and full commercial insurance.

B.5 12-month scenario

1,500 sign-ups, 150 paying users (10%), average fee ¥60, six months; 120 completions at ¥600 with a 10% service fee. Revenue ¥61,200 (subscription ¥54,000 + service ¥7,200); costs ¥46,896; contribution ≈ ¥14,300 before founder salaries and office.

B.6 Break-even

Annual fixed operating cost is ¥42,000. A paying user contributes about ¥375 after variable costs and one completion. Break-even is therefore about 112 paying users, or 7.5% of 1,500 sign-ups.

APPENDIX C

Appendix C · Glossary

Term	Plain meaning	In this plan
TAM	The theoretical ceiling of a category	1.5147 million Guangzhou students; not our users
SAM	The part we can reach and that qualifies	About 1,515 after 5% × 10% × 20%
SOM	What the first phase can actually serve	30 completions in 90 days
ARPU	Average revenue per paying user over a period	Membership is measured separately from experience revenue
CAC	Cost to acquire one paying user	¥600 per completion is a validation cost, not CAC
LTV	Gross profit one paying user leaves before churning	Needs at least 90 days of data; not invented here
Gross margin	Revenue left after direct costs	Membership costs are AI, payment and support; offline cost is pass-through
Break-even	The scale at which revenue covers costs	About 112 paying users, before founder salaries

APPENDIX D

Appendix D · Sources

1. Ministry of Education: China higher-education enrolment of about 48.73 million in 2025; the 2026 graduating cohort is estimated at 12.7 million (public data; official releases prevail).
2. Guangzhou Statistics Bureau: Guangzhou Statistical Information Handbook 2025, recording 84 higher-education institutions and 1.5147 million students in 2024.
3. Shenzhen Education Bureau and Foshan statistical releases, used only for city selection, not for Phase 1 sizing.
4. Public product information from BOSS Zhipin, Interns, KanZhun, Xiaohongshu and Bilibili, used for competitive analysis; no partnership or data licence is implied.
5. Personal Information Protection Law of the People's Republic of China; Data Security Law of the People's Republic of China.
6. Team interviews and classroom materials, October 2026 (internal).

All ratios, funnel targets, the ¥18,000 budget and the membership prices are team assumptions, test targets or proposed prices. They are not realised results. Uncontracted supply is never described as a partner.